

# Should I Continue My Sport? Decision Guide

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LAUREN FINE, MD · LAURENFINE.COM

*"The hardest part isn't the decision. It's separating what you want from what others expect."*

For athletes at a crossroads — whether to continue competing, change sports, step back, or walk away entirely. This guide helps you separate your genuine desires from external pressure, parental expectation, and the identity you've built around being an athlete.

## ◆ PART 1 — PASSION VS IDENTITY

There's a difference between loving the sport and being someone who does it. Both matter. Both are worth examining.

**When did you start this sport? Did you choose it — or did it choose you?**

*Be honest. Many athletes never had a real choice.*

**What do you love about it — specifically? What would you miss?**

*Not 'competing' in general. What exact moments light you up?*

**What don't you love? What are you relieved when you avoid?**

*This is as important as the first question.*

**Who would you be without this sport? Does that feel like loss — or relief?**

*Notice your first emotional response.*

## Part 2 — The External Pressure Audit

Be ruthlessly honest here. Whose voice is loudest in your decision — yours or someone else's?

**Who would be most affected by your decision to stop or change? How do you feel about that?**

**What have your parents, coaches, or teammates said — explicitly or implicitly — about what you should do?**

**If nobody you knew would ever find out your decision, what would you choose?**

**What are you afraid people will think if you stop? Is that fear running the decision?**

**Have you ever said 'I want to quit' out loud? What happened when you did?**

## Part 3 — Future Self · The Conversation Guide

**Imagine yourself at 30, looking back at this decision. What do you hope you chose?**

**What do you want your life to look like in 5 years — and does continuing fit that picture?**

**What would you do with the time and energy if you stepped back from the sport?**

**What is your decision — right now, with no one watching?**

### HOW TO HAVE THIS CONVERSATION WITH YOUR PARENTS OR COACH

"I want to talk about something that's been on my mind. I need you to listen before responding."

"I'm not asking for permission. I'm asking you to understand where I am."

"This isn't about giving up. It's about figuring out what I actually want."

"I need to make this decision for myself. I'd love your support either way."

### READY TO GO DEEPER?

This decision deserves a real conversation. Book a free discovery call at [laurenfine.com](https://laurenfine.com)

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